

🪔 KOLKATA DURGA PUJA PANDAL HOPPING GUIDE 2026

By Travel With Preet

Kolkata has hundreds of Durga Pujas — and the biggest mistake you can make is randomly travelling from one end of the city to another.

So we've put together our **pandal-hopping guide covering 227 pandals**, organised into:

📍 Area-wise routes
🚶 Walking circuits
🚇 Metro-wise routes
✨ North, Central, South, South-West, East & Port Kolkata
💡 Practical Puja tips

Our biggest recommendation: Pick ONE area/cluster at a time. You'll spend less time travelling and more time actually enjoying Pujo.

📍 1. AREA-WISE ROUTES

NORTH KOLKATA

We would divide North Kolkata into these clusters:

Route 1: Shyambazar → Hatibagan
Route 2: Kumartuli → Bagbazar → Shobhabazar
Route 3: Girish Park → Jorasanko

Route 4: MG Road → College Street
Route 5: Maniktala
Route 6: Ultadanga
Route 7: Dum Dum → Lake Town

⭐ OLD KOLKATA CIRCUIT

A great route if this is your first Kolkata Pujo and you want the old-city atmosphere.

Suggested order:

Baghbazar Sarbojanin
↓
Nalin Sarkar Street
↓
Kashi Bose Lane
↓
Hatibagan Sarbojanin
↓
Sikdar Bagan
↓
Kumartuli Park
↓
Kumartuli Sarbojanin
↓
Ahiritola Sarbojanin
↓
Beniatola Sarbojanin
↓
Chaltabagan Lohapatty
↓
Simla Byayam Samity
↓
Muhammad Ali Park
↓
College Square

Best for: Traditional Pujo + old Kolkata + iconic pandals.

💡 **Preet Tip:** Don't keep jumping between North and South Kolkata. Finish this belt together.

⭐ SREEBHUMI + DUM DUM CIRCUIT

Keep this separate from the Bagbazar–Kumartuli route.

Suggested order:

Sree Bhumi Sporting Club
↓
Dum Dum Park Bharat Chakra
↓
Dum Dum Park Sarbajanin
↓
Dum Dum Park Tarun Dal
↓
Tala Prattoy
↓
Telengabagan
↓
Golaghata Sammilani
↓
Dakshindari Youth

Also look out for:

Nwapara Udayan Sangha
Sinthee Sarbojanin
Tala Park
Dakshinpara
Arjunpur Amra Sabai Club

Best for: Big installations + themes + spectacle.

⚠️ **Sreebhumi can have extremely long queues**, so give yourself plenty of buffer time.

📍 2. CENTRAL KOLKATA

Useful clusters:

Bhowanipore → Chakraberia
Central → Chandni Chowk

Pandals to look out for:

Subodh Mallick Square
Kapalitola Sarbajanin
Janbazar Rajbari
Taltala Sarbojanin
Chakraberia Sarbojanin
68 Pally
76 Pally
Bhowanipur 75 Pally
22 Pally / Northern Park
Paddapukur Youth
Harish Park
Agradut Udaya Sangha
Swadhin Sangha

📍 3. SOUTH KOLKATA

South Kolkata has several different Puja belts. **Do NOT try to cover all of them in one night.**

Divide it into:

Route 1: Kalighat → Rashbehari
Route 2: Deshapriya Park → Lake
Route 3: Gariahat → Ballygunge
Route 4: Bhowanipore
Route 5: Chetla → Alipore → New Alipore
Route 6: Dhakuria → Jodhpur Park
Route 7: Santoshpur → Kasba
Route 8: Naktala → Garia → Patuli
Route 9: Haridevpur → Tollygunge

⭐ SOUTH KOLKATA BIG PANDAL CIRCUIT

Suggested route:

Badamtala Ashar Sangha
↓
66 Pally
↓
Chetla Agrani

↓
Suruchi Sangha
↓
Deshapriya Park
↓
Tridhara Sammilani
↓
Ballygunge Cultural
↓
Singhi Park
↓
Ekdalia Evergreen
↓
Bosepukur Sitala Mandir
↓
Mudiali
↓
Shib Mandir

This circuit gives you some of South Kolkata's most popular Pujo names together.

💡 **Preet Tip:** Kalighat–Rashbehari–Ballygunge becomes extremely crowded after dark. Keep extra time between pandals.

⭐ NAKTALA → GARIA → PATULI

Naktala Pally Unnayan Samity
↓
Naktala Udayan Sangha
↓
Baishnabghata Balak Samity
↓
Garia Mitali
↓
Tarun Sathi
↓
Shyama Pally
↓
Kamdahari Purbapara
↓
Patuli Sarbojanin
↓

Santoshpur Lake Pally
↓
Santoshpur Trikon Park
↓
Pally Mangal

This makes a much more manageable South Kolkata night than combining these with Kalighat.

⭐ HARIDEVPUR → TOLLYGUNGE

Haridevpur 41 Pally
↓
Vivekananda Park
↓
Ajeya Sanghati
↓
New Sporting Club
↓
Barisha Club

📍 4. SOUTH-WEST KOLKATA

BEHALA → BARISHA → THAKURPUKUR

Keep the Behala side as a separate Puja outing.

This area has enough pandals to make an entire evening out of it, so we **wouldn't combine Behala with North Kolkata or Salt Lake on the same night.**

📍 5. PORT KOLKATA

KHIDIRPUR CIRCUIT

Khidirpur and the surrounding Port area can again be explored as its own cluster.

If you're covering this belt, combine nearby pandals rather than travelling back towards North or deep South Kolkata.

📍 6. EAST KOLKATA

⭐ SALT LAKE BLOCK PUJA CIRCUIT

Take the **Green Line Metro towards Salt Lake** and use **Karunamoyee** as your main access point.

Then explore:

FD Block
↓
AE Block
↓
BJ Block
↓
Nearby Salt Lake block Pujas

Most can be combined using walking + short auto rides.

Best for: Open spaces + neighbourhood Pujo + comparatively easier movement than some of the dense North/South belts.

You can keep **New Town** as another East Kolkata circuit rather than trying to combine everything.

🚇 7. DURGA PUJA BY METRO

Metro can save you HOURS during Pujo.

🔵 BLUE LINE — NORTH KOLKATA

DUM DUM

Sinthee Sarbojanin

BELGACHIA

Useful for:

Tala Park
Tala Prattoy
Dakshinpara
Arjunpur Amra Sabai Club
Dum Dum Park Bharat Chakra
Dum Dum Park Sarbajanin
Dum Dum Park Tarun Dal
Sree Bhumi Sporting Club
Golaghata Sammilani
Dakshindari Youth
Telengabagan

SHYAMBAZAR

Useful for:

Baghbazar Sarbojanin
Sikdar Bagan
Hatibagan Nabinpally
Nalin Sarkar Street
Hatibagan Sarbojanin
Kashi Bose Lane
Lalabagan Nabankur

SHOBHABAZAR SUTANUTI

Useful for:

Sovabazar Rajbari
Jagat Mukherjee Park
Kumartuli Sarbojanin
Kumartuli Park
Beniatola Sarbojanin
Ahiritola Sarbojanin

✨ This is one of the best stations for experiencing the older side of Kolkata Pujo.

GIRISH PARK

Jorasanko Sadharan
Chorebagan Sarbojanin

Simla Byayam Samity
Chaltabagan Lohapatty

MG ROAD

Muhammad Ali Park
College Square
Santosh Mitra Square
Sealdah Athletic Club

🚇 8. BLUE LINE — CENTRAL KOLKATA

CENTRAL

Subodh Mallick Square
Kapalitola Sarbajanin

CHANDNI CHOWK

Janbazar Rajbari
Taltala Sarbojanin

RABINDRA SADAN

Chakraberia Sarbojanin

NETAJI BHAVAN

68 Pally
76 Pally
Bhowanipur 75 Pally
22 Pally / Northern Park
Paddapukur Youth
Harish Park
Agradut Udaya Sangha
Swadhin Sangha

🚇 9. BLUE LINE — SOUTH KOLKATA

JATIN DAS PARK

23 Pally
Forward Club
Matri Mandir
Bakul Bagan
Maddox Square

Maddox is especially famous for the Pujo adda and atmosphere.

KALIGHAT

One of the biggest Pujo clusters.

Useful for:

Suruchi Sangha
Chetla Agrani
66 Pally
Badamtala Ashar Sangha
Deshapriya Park
Tridhara Sammilani
Ballygunge Cultural
Hindusthan Park
Hindusthan Club
Singhi Park
Ekdalia Evergreen
Bosepukur Sitala Mandir
Rajdanga Naba Uday Sangha

⚠️ This belt gets VERY busy. Don't expect to cover every pandal quickly.

RABINDRA SAROBAR

Shib Mandir
Mudiali

MAHANAYAK UTTAM KUMAR

Haridevpur 41 Pally
Vivekananda Park
Ajeya Sanghati

New Sporting Club
Barisha Club

NETAJI / KUDGHAT

Naktala Pally Unnayan Samity

MASTERDA SURYA SEN

Regent Park
Roynagar Unyan Samity

GITANJALI

Naktala Udayan Sangha
Baishnabghata Balak Samity

KAVI NAZRUL

Naba Durga
Garia Mitali
Tarun Sathi
Shyama Pally
Kamdahari Purbapara

SHAHID KHUDIRAM

Patuli Sarbojanin

KAVI SUBHASH

Santoshpur Lake Pally
Santoshpur Trikon Park
Pally Mangal

🟢 10. GREEN LINE — SALT LAKE

KARUNAMOYEE

Use this for the Salt Lake block-puja circuit:

FD Block
AE Block
BJ Block

- surrounding block Pujas

You can walk between some clusters and use autos/e-rickshaws for the rest.

🔄 SWITCHING BETWEEN NORTH/SOUTH & SALT LAKE

Esplanade is an important Blue ↔ Green Line interchange, making it useful when moving between the traditional Kolkata circuits and Salt Lake.

But our advice?

Don't spend your Pujo night changing areas constantly.

One good circuit > 10 random pandals across Kolkata.

🚶 11. WALKING ROUTES

Some areas are best experienced on foot because several pandals sit relatively close together.

WALK 1 — SHYAMBAZAR + HATIBAGAN

Baghbazar
→ Hatibagan
→ Nalin Sarkar Street
→ Sikdar Bagan
→ Kashi Bose Lane

WALK 2 — KUMARTULI + AHIRITOLA

Kumartuli Park
→ Kumartuli Sarbojanin
→ Ahiritola
→ Beniatola

Perfect if you want the narrow lanes and old-North-Kolkata Pujo atmosphere.

WALK 3 — COLLEGE STREET BELT

Muhammad Ali Park
→ College Square
→ nearby Central Kolkata pandals

WALK 4 — RASHBEHARI / DESHAPRIYA BELT

Deshapriya Park
→ Tridhara Sammilani
→ nearby Ballygunge/Gariahat pandals

WALK 5 — SOUTH KOLKATA

Mudiali
→ Shib Mandir
→ nearby Lake-area Pujas

💡 **Important:** These are suggested clusters, not strict turn-by-turn walking directions. Barricades, police diversions and crowd-control routes can change during Pujo.

🗓️ HOW WE WOULD PLAN MULTIPLE PUJO NIGHTS

If you have several evenings in Kolkata, instead of trying to see everything together:

Night 1: Bagbazar + Shyambazar + Hatibagan + Kumartuli
Night 2: Dum Dum + Lake Town + Sreebhumi
Night 3: Kalighat + Rashbehari + Ballygunge
Night 4: Naktala + Garia + Patuli
Night 5: Salt Lake + New Town
Night 6: Behala + Barisha

This way every night has its own vibe and you aren't spending half your Pujo sitting in traffic.

⚠️ PUJA SURVIVAL TIPS

1. Start earlier than everyone else.
If possible, start in the afternoon. Crowds increase massively after sunset.

2. Metro > car for many routes.
Road closures, barricades and traffic diversions are common during Pujo.

3. Don't depend on one exact walking path.
Police may create one-way pedestrian routes depending on crowds.

4. Wear comfortable shoes.
You will walk MUCH more than you expect.

5. Carry water — but travel light.
Avoid carrying unnecessary bags when entering crowded pandals.

6. Keep your phone charged.
Screenshots of routes + a power bank can save you when networks become congested.

7. Don't chase numbers.
Seeing 8–10 pandals properly is better than rushing through 25 just to tick them off.

8. Check Metro timings before leaving.
Special Puja services and late-night timings can change each year/day. Check the latest official schedule before depending on an overnight Metro.

9. Expect queues at the famous pandals.
Especially Sreebhumi and the major North/South Kolkata names.

10. Keep buffer time.
A route that looks short on Maps can take much longer during Pujo.

❤️ OUR BIGGEST PUJO TIP

Don't make Kolkata Durga Puja a checklist.

Pick an area.

Walk through the lanes.

Stop for puchka.

Have a roll.

Listen to the dhaak.

Watch the crowds.

Do some pandal hopping.

And enjoy the madness.

Because Pujo in Kolkata isn't only about how many pandals you managed to cover.

It's about everything that happens between them. ❤️

— Travel With Preet

📌 Save this guide before pandal hopping.

📤 Send it to your Pujo gang.

And follow **@travelwpreet** for more Kolkata, Bengal & travel guides.